Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

TR103
Contrastive Analysis
MTA - Makeup
All Branches
2025-2026 /Fall
Date:4 Dec. 2025
5:00 – 6:30

Number of Exam Pages: (including this cover sheet)	**3**	**Time Allowed:**	**1.5 hours**

INSTRUCTIONS:

1. Read the questions carefully before you answer.
2. Answer all the questions in the answer booklet clearly.
3. Write all your answers in ink NOT pencil.
4. Edit and proofread your language.
5. No dictionaries are allowed.

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Question 1: Short Notes (5 marks: 15 minutes)

In 60-80 words, discuss how evoked meaning arises from language variation. Differentiate between the types of meaning evoked by dialect and register. Support your answer with a relevant example for each.

Question 2: Strategy Identification (5 marks: 10 minutes)

Identify and name the strategy used by the translator to achieve equivalence for the underlined words. (2.5 marks each)

	ST	TT
1.	Mangroves and coral reefs along thousands of miles of coast have harbored nurseries of fish species.	وفرت أشجار المانجروف والشعاب المرجانية الممتدة لآلاف الأميال من الساحل مأوى للعديد من أنواع السمك.
2.	الشريعة هي كلّ ما أنزله الله لعباده من معتقدات وعبادات.	The religious law is all that God has revealed for His servants in terms of beliefs and acts of worship.

Question 3: Error Identification and Correction (5 marks: 20 minutes)

Read the excerpt below and its translation and answer the questions which follow.

ST	TT
We need to address the elephant in the room*: our marketing strategy is failing. Let's stop beating around the bush. *a major problem	نحتاج إلى معالجة الفيل في الغرفة، فاستراتيجية التسويق لدينا تفشل. فلنتوقف عن ضرب الأدغال.

1. **Identify and name the TWO distinct types of translation errors evident in the target text (TT). (2 marks: 1 mark for identifying each error)**
2. **Provide a correct Arabic translation for the entire sentence. (3 marks for a correct, idiomatic translation)**

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Question 4: Critical Reflection (10 marks: 45 minutes)

Read the English translation below for the Arabic news on elections in Iraq and write a critical reflection of 120-150 words drawing on your understanding of Baker's (2018) concept of grammatical equivalence. In your reflection, discuss the strategies and techniques the translator used to overcome non-equivalence on the grammatical level.

ST	TT
يستعد العراق لإجراء سادس انتخابات برلمانية بعد عام 2003، والمقررة في نوفمبر/تشرين الثاني من العام الحالي، في أجواء تبدو مختلفة تماماً عن الدورات السابقة، إذ تأتي هذه الانتخابات في ظل دعوة مقتدى الصدر، زعيم التيار الوطني الشيعي (الذي كان يسمى بالتيار الصدري)، أنصاره إلى مقاطعتها بشكل كامل، في خطوة تعد غير مسبوقة من حيث تأثيرها المحتمل على الخارطة السياسية العراقية. وتوسعت دعوة الصدر في دعوته لمقاطعة الانتخابات لتشمل منع تعليق اللافتات الانتخابية للمرشحين في مدينة الصدر شرقي بغداد، المركز الرئيسي للتيار، وهو مشهد لم تألفه الحملات الانتخابية في الدورات الماضية، حتى في أكثر فتراتها توتراً. Source: https://www.bbc.com/arabic/articles/cgr40824pk2o	Iraq is preparing for its sixth parliamentary elections since 2003, scheduled for November of this year, in an atmosphere that appears entirely different from previous cycles. These elections come amidst a call by Muqtada al-Sadr, the leader of the Shiite National Current (formerly known as the Sadrist Current), for his supporters to completely boycott them—an unprecedented move in terms of its potential impact on the Iraqi political landscape. Al-Sadr's call for a boycott has expanded to include a ban on hanging election posters for candidates in Sadr City, east of Baghdad, the main stronghold of the current. This is a scene that election campaigns in previous cycles were not accustomed to, even during their most tense periods.

End of Exam!

Best Wishes ☺

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